CRACKING

Cracking is where someone edits a program source so that the code can be exploited or modified. A cracker (also called a black hat or dark side hacker) is a malicious or criminal hacker. "Cracking" means trying to get into computer systems in order to steal, corrupt, or illegitimately view data.

A cracker is someone who breaks into someone else's computer system, often on a network, bypassing passwords or licenses in computer programs.

They may send official e-mail requesting some sensitive information. It may look like a legitimate e-mail from bank or other official institution.

17.3 Cyber Security and Threats

Cyber attacks are launched primarily for causing significant damage to a computer system or for stealing important information from an individual or from an organization. Cyber security is a collection of various technologies, processes and measures that reduces the risk of cyber attacks and protects organizations and individuals from computer based threats.

TYPES OF CYBER ATTACKS

Malware is a type of software designed through which the criminals gain illegal access to software and cause damage.

Cyber Security Threats

In recent years, most of the individuals and enterprises are facing problems due to the weaknesses inherent in security systems and compromised organizational infrastructures. Different types of Cyber Security Threats are categorized as below:

Phishing

Phishing is a type of computer crime used to attack, steal user data, including login name, password and credit card numbers. It occurs when an attacker targets a victim into opening an e-mail or an instant text message. The attacker uses phishing to distribute malicious links or attachments that can perform a variety of functions, including the extraction of sensitive login credentials from victims.

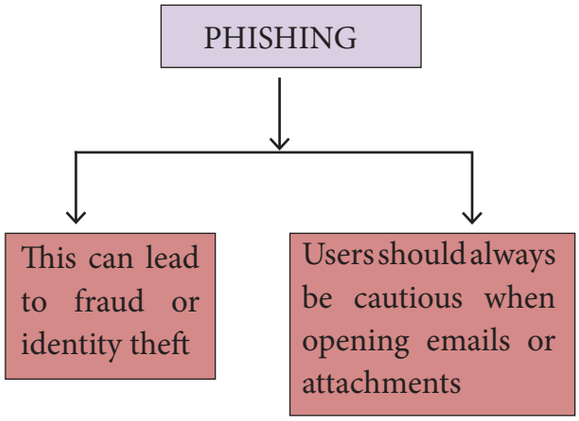


Figure 17.4 Diagrammatic representation of Phishing

Pharming

Pharming is a scamming practice in which malicious code is installed on a personal computer or server, misdirecting users to fraudulent web sites without their knowledge or permission. Pharming has been called "**phishing without a trap**". It is another way hackers attempt to manipulate users on the Internet. It is a cyber-attack intended to redirect a website's traffic to a fake site.

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